

AI TOOLS & USE CASES

AI Tool	Best Use	Practical Engineering Uses	Free Tier	Paid Tier
ChatGPT	General-purpose AI assistant – Codex – Coding, AI Agent – Image Generator	Document review, fault-finding directed questions for support based on manuals and source documents, reports, procedures, risk assessments, data analysis, research	Yes – capable free version with usage limits	Plus ~US\$20/month – higher limits and more advanced tools (OpenAI Help Center)
Microsoft Copilot	Microsoft 365 workplace AI – Also General-purpose AI assistant	Word reports, Excel analysis, PowerPoint creation, Teams meeting summaries, emails and workplace information	Some Copilot capabilities available free	Microsoft 365 Copilot Business ~AU\$27–31/user/month depending on offer/billing (Microsoft)
Claude	Large documents & detailed analysis – Coding / Software – AI Agent	Review standards, procedures, technical reports, specifications and compare large documents .Detailed reasoning	Yes – limited usage	Paid plans available – higher limits and advanced models
Google Gemini	General AI / Google ecosystem	Research, document analysis, drafting, brainstorming, data interpretation and Google Workspace tasks	Yes	Google AI paid plans – higher limits / advanced capabilities
NotebookLM	Your own source documents	Load standards, procedures, manuals or training material and ask questions specifically against those sources	Yes	Premium capability through Google paid plans
Manus	Autonomous AI agent / AI agent / completing multi-step tasks – General AI assistant	Give it multi-step research, analysis, reporting and creation tasks. Research a topic, collect information, analyse it and produce reports or other finished outputs	Yes – 300 daily credits, limited agent capability	Pro from ~US\$20/month (Manus Help Center)
Perplexity	AI research/search	Quickly research technical topics, equipment, standards developments, industry information and find sources.	Yes – basic searches + limited Pro searches	Pro available – more advanced searches, models and file analysis (Perplexity AI)
GitHub Copilot	Coding & software	Python, scripts, automation, engineering tools and software development	Yes – limited coding/AI usage	Pro US\$10/month, higher tiers available (GitHub)
Canva AI	Visual content	Training material, safety posters, diagrams, presentations and awareness material	Yes – limited AI uses	Pro ~A\$165/year for an individual (Canva)
Gamma	AI presentations	Turn engineering notes/reports into presentations	Yes – limited	Paid plans available – more AI generation/export capability
Otter.ai	Meetings & transcription	Meeting transcription, summaries, actions and searchable records	Yes – 300 transcription min/month	Pro from US\$8.33/user/month annually (Otter.ai)
Power BI + AI	Data analysis & dashboards	Defect trends, downtime, maintenance, assurance and performance dashboards	Yes – create reports for personal use	Power BI Pro AU\$21/user/month; Premium Per User AU\$35.90 (Microsoft)

